thought in China while demonizing the West and its values.[73] In addition, Beijing continues a policy of severe repression in both Tibet and Xinjiang, paralleling its hardening line on Hong Kong. The China of coming decades will be a more tightly controlled and surveilled society, in which even elites will be uncertain of their position.

China's hard line at home is being replicated abroad to a worrying degree. The very fact of China's brazen arrogance in making ideological demands on countries, corporations, universities, and media over issues like Taiwan or Xinjiang points to both deep insecurity and a disturbing aggressiveness. No other major trading country's government, not even Japan's at the height of its power in the 1980s, has intimidated and threatened foreign governments or businesses for perceived issues of national interest. Yet perhaps worse, Western corporations, political leaders, academics, and opinion leaders are all too often susceptible to the new China rules. Whether cravenly begging forgiveness or helping to whitewash Chinese behavior, Western self-censorship is both self-defeating and dangerous. Little by little, as reports such as those from the US-China Commission and European think tanks show, Western attitudes and behaviors have been shifting to accommodate the Chinese.

Some Western corporate leaders are trying to make the case that running away from China makes no sense. "We believe in engaging with governments even when we disagree," stated Apple's Tim Cook when discussing Chinese control over the internet inside the country.[74] But engagement is a two-way street, and Beijing has shown no willingness to accommodate. Instead, the expected growth of China's consumer sector means that it will remain a magnet for Western businesses for years to come, while its growing military strength will give it an outsize voice in political and security issues both throughout the Indo-Pacific region and globally. Its intimidation tactics thus may not abate anytime soon. Over time, an ingrained Western acquiescence to subordination to Chinese national interests and purported national feelings will further embolden Beijing's abusive behavior. Either the West will lose the will to speak truth to power or relations will reach a